NEO-COLONIALISM: CONCEPT

The term 'neo-colonialism' was popularized in the wake of decolonialization, largely through the activities of scholars and leaders from the newly independent states of Africa and the Pan-African Movement. Many of these leaders came together with those of other post-colonial states at the Bandung Conference of 1955, leading to the formation of the Non-Aligned Movement. The All-African Peoples' Conference (AAPC) meetings of the late 1950s and early 1960s spread the critique of neo-colonialism. The Tunis conference of 1960 and Cairo Conference of 1961 specified their opposition to what they labelled as neo-colonialism. Their four-page *Resolution on Neocolonialism* is cited as a landmark for having presented a collectively arrived at definition of neo-colonialism and a description of its main features. Throughout the Cold War, NAM as well as organizations like the Organization of Solidarity with the People of Asia, Africa and Latin America defined neo-colonialism as a primary collective enemy of these independent states.

Neo-colonialism is best described as "The survival of the colonial system in spite of formal recognition of political independence in emerging countries which became the victims of indirect and subtle form of domination by political, economic, social, military and technical forces".[9]

The mechanisms of neo-colonialism are designed to serve the interest of continuation of economic dependence of former colonies by the former colonial powers. This is ensured by the integration of the dependent countries into colonial economic blocs through capital investments, loans, aid, unequal exchange and finances directly controlled by the colonial powers.

Difference between Colonialism and Neo-Colonialism

Kwame Nkrumah, who in 1957 became the leader of the newly independent Ghana, expounded his idea in his book *Neo-Colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism*, in 1965. He stated, "The essence of neo-colonialism is that the State which is subject to it is, in theory, independent and has all the outward trappings of